



May 2006

Glad To Be Reaching You

I'm a student from a small town in Uttar Pradesh. I'm not rich, so I couldn't purchase *Digit* earlier—but now I save my pocket money, and have been reading *Digit* since June 2005.

There's no real computer infrastructure in my area, and no broadband—so I either have to travel to Lucknow or make do with BSNL's 30 Kbps at my place. I give credit to *Digit* for my being able to solve computer-related problems amongst my circle of friends.

There is a lack of books on 3D game design and programming here. Since it's becoming a great career option, it would be great if you could provide some material on it. Anyway, I just want to thank you for your good work. The *Fast Track* is great and is worth it.

Abhishek Dwivedi
Uttar Pradesh

Dear Abhishek,
Thanks for giving us credit—we work hard, and are delighted when we receive feedback like yours. Upcoming issues of *Fast Track* might very well cover areas such as 3D design. In addition, we're trying to include more articles in the magazine on career options—and the areas you've mentioned will likely be featured.

—Associate Editor

The Unrepentant Pirate!

I am regular reader of *Digit*. I want to know why PC games cost so much! Here in my college, I conducted a poll how many boys buy original game CDs. Of 462 boys who play games, 454 buy pirated copies. We can get games for Rs 25 to

Rs 150 whereas an original game costs more like Rs 1,000 to Rs 3,000 or more.

Most game buyers are from middle class families. It's not possible for us to buy such expensive games. I'm happy with pirated games, and till now I have not faced any problems while playing them. Instead of spending so much on games, I'd rather use the money to upgrade my PC or buy a new mobile! We are gadget freaks, and I don't think the companies can fight piracy. Yes, they can fight if they sell their games for as low as Rs 25. We are Indians and want *sasta*, *sundar* and *tikau*...

Baskey
Bhubaneswar

Dear Baskey,

We have reasons for being proud to be Indian, and wanting *sasta*, *sundar* and *tikau* is not one of them. There's a lot I'd like to tell you, but I'll keep this response short.

First off, you've said that only eight out of 462 buy original games—and you seem to have been encouraged by this fact. Just because everyone does it doesn't make it right: you're doing something wrong. "Everyone" throws garbage onto the street: does that make it right? If "every policeman" collected *hafta*; would that make it right?

Second, game companies spend money developing their games. If you don't pay, they stand to lose money. Think about a scenario where everyone bought only pirated versions—how would the companies survive, improve, innovate?

As for fighting piracy, there's a trend towards gaming companies using uncrackable protection for their discs. CDs can be easily replicated these days, but this won't be the case a couple of years from now—you'll have to pay up! We suggest you start practising...

To sum it up, please refrain from promoting piracy, and prepare yourself for the time when games will no longer be "free"!

— Associate Editor

Good Mag, Great Service

Digit has always been the best! I'd heard about the magazine earlier, but only now have I seen what a good magazine it is. You've helped me get a very good PC.

I purchased the December 2005 issue and the DVD was faulty. I wasn't able to mail you earlier, complained only in March. I had no hope that I would get a new one. But thanks to your great customer service, I got the disc replaced immediately! Thanks for keeping my trust!

Here's a suggestion—how about including a Tips & Tricks corner dedicated to Linux in every issue?

Sachin
Via E-mail

Dear Sachin,

We do try to keep our readers satisfied—thanks for writing in about this incident! Regarding Linux, unfortunately, there simply aren't enough *Digit* readers who are Linux users to warrant Linux Tips & Tricks in every issue. Just take a look at the Q&A section of any of our issues, and you'll see what I mean—most of our readers use Windows. Of course, this might change over the next couple of years.

—Associate Editor

Pack In The Bytes!

I'm a great fan of your magazine. I was reading *Digit* in the past, I'm reading *Digit* in the present, and I will be reading it in the future too! Your articles are informative and broaden our knowledge. Tips & Tricks and the game cheats on the CDs and DVDs are helpful for students like us. The brilliant presentation of the *Fast Track* books has solved many of my problems. The software, games and other information available on the CDs and DVDs are superb! I would like to suggest that you increase the number of software on the CDs and DVDs, and give us articles and Tips & Tricks relating to the software available on the discs. If possible, please publish a *Fast Track* on graphic design or Web page designing in the coming issues.

Riwaj Acharya
Via E-mail

Dear Riway,

We can't really increase the number of software we provide on our discs. We have a certain amount of space, and we try as hard as we can to include only the best software. Besides, it's not the number of software that counts, but the quality!

We choose topics for our *Fast Track* series based on what is feasible and what readers want. Several readers, including you, have mentioned graphic and Web design, and we are indeed contemplating the idea.

—Associate Editor

Games All The Way

My life is incomplete without computers, and without you my knowledge about computers is incomplete. I started reading your magazine when I was in class II. It's been a long journey. It is due to you that I was the best at computers in the entire